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Registration No.		VISIONIAS		Assignment Code	
4	6	1	6	4	6
4	2	5	4	1	6
Classroom Assignment Sheet				164630	
Name: J A Y A N T K U N A W A T					
Subject: MHP Batch: RB33 Submission Date: Total Marks					
Question - Discuss the <u>key provisions</u> & <u>implications</u> of the Indian Councils Act 1909, also known as Morley-Minto Reforms, on <u>Indian representation in governance</u>. The Morley Minto Reforms represented the <u>British attempt to reconcile growing Nationalist aspirations with imperial control</u>. Instead of democratizing governance, the reforms increased the political representation in <u>carefully calibrated ways</u> while ensuring British supremacy. In this sense, the Morley-Minto reforms <u>sowed the seeds of communal politics</u> via <u>separate electorates</u>. <u>Key provisions</u> ① <u>Separate electorate</u> - was introduced for for Muslims with lower qualification in income for voting as compared to Hindus. Additionally, the Muslims were given representation in central legislative council beyond their population percentage. ② <u>Indirect Elections</u> - The elections for non-official members also enabled the majority in provincial councils. The central council still possessed the majority of official members.					

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10

Effective introduction that frames the reforms as balancing nationalist aspirations with imperial control while maintaining British supremacy

Well-structured presentation of separate electorates with accurate details about differential qualifications for Muslims and Hindus.

Good explanation of indirect elections, though you could briefly explain how this system limited genuine Indian participation despite appearing progressive.

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③ Expansion of Councils - The number of elected members were increased in both provincial and central legislative councils.

④ Composition of Councils - 69 (CLC)

$$\underbrace{37}_{\text{official members}} + \underbrace{5}_{\text{Nominated}} + \underbrace{27}_{\text{Non-official members who will be elected.}}$$

Moreover, the seats in central leg. council (CLC) were reserved for muslims, British capitalists, Landlords etc.

⑤ Appointment of Indian in Governor general (GG) legislative council. Satyendra Prasad Sinha was the 1st Indian to join GG - executive council.

⑥ Legislative powers - Indian council members were allowed to do discussion on separate budget items, also enabled to ask supplementary questions.

Implications on Indian representation

① The role of Indians in the councils were close to that of an advisory body.

② Limited Franchise - Many Indians and women lacked voting rights and political representation.

It was seen as a mixed constitutionalism with autocracy.

Good mention of S.P. Sinha's appointment as the first Indian in the Executive Council - this symbolic inclusion created an appearance of power-sharing while maintaining British controls.

Excellent characterization of Indians' role as 'advisory' and the system as 'mixed constitutionalism with autocracy' - this captures the essence of the reforms' limitations.

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Evaluation
Feedback:
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	Context	Content	Structure - presentation	Language	Word limit	Overall performance
Excellent						
Good						
Average						

Excellent breakdown of council composition with numerical details (37+5+27) demonstrates comprehensive knowledge of the reforms' structure.

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Name: _____					
Subject: _____ Batch: _____ Submission Date: _____				Total Marks	
Question-					
<u>Implications on Indian National movement</u>					
① The reforms <u>severely constrained</u> the Indian National Congress (INC) as the communal politics took precedence.					
② Major <u>victory</u> for Muslim League - It supported the <u>two nation theory</u> and the climax was witnessed decades later in the demand of a separate state - Pakistan.					
③ The reforms <u>nurtured separatism</u> in India. "In giving separate electorates, we are sowing dragon teeth, the harvest will be bitter" — Morley.					
Thus, the <u>Morley Minto reforms</u> showed a <u>dual character</u> of British constitutional policy in India. <u>Incremental political reforms</u> while ensuring colonial supremacy + transforming constitutional reforms into <u>instruments of Imperial politics</u> .					

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The Muslim League did not explicitly support the 'two-nation theory' at this time. While separate electorates did contribute to communal division, the two-nation theory became prominent much later.

Effective use of Morley's quote about 'sowing dragon teeth' to reinforce your point about the divisive legacy of separate electorates.

Strong conclusion synthesizing the dual character of British policy.